Where this thing actually stands

A straight read on Vanta — what is built, what is holding, what is thin, and what the watch has to do with any of it. Written for the person who has to trust it, not for the person who built it.

THE SHORT VERSION

The machine is finished to a level most one-person builds never reach: 68 tables, 55 backend jobs, 13 scheduled sweeps, 550 passing tests, and one rule enforced everywhere — **capture never executes**. What it does not have yet is your life inside it. Right now the tank is nearly empty, and an empty companion looks quiet no matter how good the engine is.

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PLAIN TALK · NO CLAIM A RECORD CANNOT BACK

What it is, in one breath

Vanta is a place where things you say, snap, forward or wear turn into records with a source and a date — and then wait for you. Messaging feeds it. Messaging never drives it. Every real move follows the same three beats: **plan, approve, execute**, and all three happen inside the platform, under your thumb.

Four rooms, and that is the whole map:

Today	What is live right now. Your body, the weather, what changed, what is next.
Work	Where things stand, one thing to start with, then the desks: projects, inbox, commitments, actions, briefs, documents, schedule.
Ask	Durable threads with real context attached — notes, files, images, research. It reads what you point it at.
Receipts	Every state change, with time, source and rollback where rollback is real.

How wearables actually work

Your body is **context, not a controller**. Readings change how Vanta talks — shorter when you are training, quieter when you are spent — and nothing else. No reading routes a note, books a class, sends a message or approves a thing.

There are three ways in, and they are not equally easy. Straight talk on each:

Bluetooth strap easiest, 10 seconds	Open **/wearable-loop** on your phone, tap Connect, pick the strap. Live heart rate, on screen, no account anywhere. Catch: it only reads while that page is open, and it needs a real Bluetooth heart-rate strap or a watch that broadcasts one. An Apple Watch will not hand its heart rate to a browser.
Your phone ten-minute one-off	The page mints a private link. You paste it into one Apple Shortcuts automation that posts steps, sleep and workouts each morning. Set it once and it runs forever. That is the path that actually gets you fourteen days of history.
By hand instant	Type a number in. It is marked as entered by hand and never dressed up as a sensor reading.

Consent is two switches — heart rate, and daily activity (steps, sleep, workouts). Off means off: nothing read, nothing stored, and every panel says "switched off" instead of showing an empty chart that looks like bad news. A day with no record is a grey gap, never a zero. Vanta will not read your silence as a fact about you.

IS IT READY? — HONESTLY

Ready: the table, the ingest link, the daily sweep, posture, the Today body panel, the Work desk body line, and **/watch** with fourteen days of steps and nights, forty-eight hours of heart rate, workouts, and a Compare sheet. Currently one real reading is in there — the test workout from this morning. Not ready: there is no App Store app doing the hand-off for you, so the phone path is a shortcut you install yourself, and every comparison will say "not enough history" until roughly two weeks of readings land. That is the correct answer, just not a satisfying one.

What is built and holding

Capture	Telegram (text, voice, photos), inbound email with attachments, website forms, shared-target uploads, handwriting read off a photo by OCR, and the watch. All of it lands as a draft with a source.
Thinking	Sherlock — nine deterministic detectors plus a nightly pattern scan and a weekly digest. Every finding can show you the evidence that triggered it, and you can tell it "not right".
Awareness	Drift, silence and risk detectors, relevance and urgency scoring, quiet hours, an attention budget, and one nudge at a time. It earned the right to speak by spending weeks in shadow mode first.
Time	Read-only calendar feeds synced every twenty minutes, and sync reports a *diff* — what changed — never just "synchronized".
Documents	Draft, review, obligation extraction, PDF and Word export, version compare.
Receipts	43 audit events already recorded on this account, each with time, actor and payload. Undo only appears where rollback is genuinely possible.
Under it	68 tables with row-level security, scope isolation on every read (personal / workspace / admin), 13 scheduled jobs, 550 tests green.

The one honest problem

Here is the number that matters more than any of the above. Right now, in the live database: **0 projects, 0 notes, 0 commitments, 0 actions, 0 documents, 0 calendar feeds.** 354 capture routes are configured and waiting. The wiring is done; nothing is flowing through it.

So when you say you do not know where this platform is — that is not a comprehension failure on your side. You are looking at a set of rooms that are correctly, truthfully empty. Every surface says so plainly instead of faking content, which is the right behaviour and also the reason it feels like less than it is.

The fix is not more features. It is one week of real use: forward the emails, photograph the notes, let the shortcut post the steps, open one project and attach things to it. The thinking layer has nothing to think about yet.

Where it is still rough

• Phone hand-off is a manual shortcut, not an app.
• Bluetooth reads only while the page is open.
• Every trend and comparison is history-hungry; two weeks minimum before they say anything.
• Sherlock and awareness are only as smart as the volume you give them — near zero input, near zero output.
• The desks are comprehensible now, but Work still holds the most concepts of any room.

Room to expand — in order

1 · Feed it	A week of real capture. Nothing else changes the experience as much, and it costs no build time.
2 · Nikki's recipients	Notification list to train@lamaimuaythai.com and lamaimuaythaicamp@gmail.com, Ralph off, your Gmail untouched.
3 · Weekly body digest	One quiet Sunday line: nights, training, steps against your usual. Reads like the Sherlock digest.
4 · Ground Truth Hub bridge	The signed outbound bridge exists; point Nikki's hub at it once Vanta's own loop has a week behind it.
5 · CampCore last	Booking and payment logic stays untouchable from chat. Members ask, coaches read, managers get summaries.

The verdict

You are not wrong about it being badass, and you are right to be suspicious of your own read. What exists is a disciplined, mature companion platform with an unusual spine: it refuses to act on your behalf, it refuses to invent numbers, and it tells you where every fact came from. That restraint is the hardest thing in this category and you have it.

What you do not have is proof. Proof only arrives as records. Give it a week of your actual life and the same platform will read completely differently — not because anything was added, but because it will finally have something true to say.

Vanta · capture never executes · every record keeps its source